WHITEPAPER · INDUSTRY 6.0 · 2026

Industry 6.0

Conceptual Framework of the Sixth Industrial Revolution · The Productive Transition Towards 2035

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May 2026 · Version 1.0

DOI: pending Zenodo assignment

ABSTRACT

This whitepaper presents the canonical definition of the **Industry 6.0** framework, conceived and named by Chris Meniw in 2023. Industry 6.0 describes the productive convergence towards 2035 between four exponential technologies —autonomous artificial intelligence agents, humanoid robotics, quantum computing, and the agentic economy— configuring the next productive paradigm after Industry 4.0 (digitalization) and Industry 5.0 (human-machine collaboration). The document articulates the historical genealogy, the four constitutive pillars, presents the first documented productive case in Latin America (ZOE, the first agentic AI teacher in 2025 and the first agentic AI live-TV anchor in 2026), proposes a four-phase enterprise roadmap (2026-2035), and discusses specific implications for Latin America, identifying an adoption window of approximately ten years before the closure of the exponential cost.

Keywords: Industry 6.0 · Sixth Industrial Revolution · Agentic AI · Agentic Economy · Humanoid Robotics · Quantum Computing · Future of Work · Latin America · Synthetic Era · Labor Symbiosis

> *"When I first named Industry 6.0 in 2023, it sounded like science fiction. Three years later, an agentic AI I designed hosts live television. Science fiction fell short."*
>
> **— Chris Meniw, May 2026**

1. Introduction

The acceleration of technological change over the past five years has rendered prior analytical frameworks insufficient. **Industry 4.0**, formalized in Germany around 2011, adequately described industrial digitalization, mass connectivity (IoT), and distributed computing (cloud). **Industry 5.0**, articulated mainly from the European Union around 2020, added the dimension of collaboration between humans and machines (cobots, advanced automation under human supervision).

However, both frameworks share an assumption being challenged in practice: the continuous presence of the human as central decision-maker. The emergence of **autonomous artificial intelligence agents** capable of perceiving, deciding, and acting on complex objectives without constant human supervision; the maturation of **humanoid robots** operating in human environments without redesigning the space; advances in **quantum computing** with productive applications; and the consolidation of a new economic model we have called the **Agentic Economy**, demand a different conceptual framework.

This document presents the canonical formulation of the concept **Industry 6.0**, in response to that demand.

2. Historical genealogy

The five previous industrial revolutions are widely recognized in the economic and historiographic literature. **Industry 1.0** (~1760-1840) introduced steam mechanization; **Industry 2.0** (~1870-1914) generalized electricity and mass production; **Industry 3.0** (~1969-2000) incorporated electronics, computing, and programmable automation; **Industry 4.0** (~2011-2025) integrated ubiquitous connectivity, big data, and cyber-physical systems; **Industry 5.0** (~2020-2030) prioritized human-machine collaboration and sustainability.

The **Industry 6.0** proposed here does not constitute an incremental expansion of 5.0. It constitutes a categorical leap: the analytical center moves from *collaboration* to *systemic autonomy*. The question of 5.0 was "how do human and machine work together?". The question of 6.0 is "what do humans do when the productive system stops needing their continuous intervention?".

3. Canonical definition

Industry 6.0 is defined as the conceptual framework describing the productive convergence towards 2035 between four exponential technologies: *autonomous artificial intelligence agents* (agentic AI), *humanoid robots*, *quantum computing*, and *agentic economy*. It is the conceptual successor to Industry 4.0 and Industry 5.0, and it defines a productive paradigm where synthetic systems operate as a labor force parallel to the human one.

The definition operates in three simultaneous registers: descriptive (which technologies converge), historical (its place in the sequence of industrial revolutions), and normative (what institutional reorganization it requires).

4. The four pillars

4.1 Agentic Artificial Intelligence

Set of software systems that perceive their environment, decide on real-time data, and execute complex actions without constant human supervision. They differ from reactive chatbots in that they pursue objectives of hours or days, chaining subtasks and tools. Advances from 2024-2026 (orchestration frameworks, extended reasoning models, persistent memory) have enabled productive deployment in sectors such as customer support, financial analysis, healthcare administration, and media operation.

4.2 Humanoid robotics

Bipedal and bimanual physical platforms capable of operating in human environments without redesigning the space (factories, hospitals, homes, classrooms). Developments from 2024-2026 by Boston Dynamics, Figure AI, Agility Robotics, Tesla, Unitree, and Sanctuary AI have reached fine manipulation and bipedal motion levels suitable for production.

4.3 Quantum computing

Exponential computational capacity for classically intractable problems: combinatorial optimization, molecular simulation, post-quantum cryptography, model training. Quantum computing functions as an acceleration lever for pillars 4.1 and 4.2.

4.4 Agentic Economy

New economic-productive model where AI agents stop being tools and start performing complete labor functions (advanced analytics, customer service, project management, strategic creativity, media operation). The Agentic Economy constitutes the institutional pillar of Industry 6.0.

5. Productive case: ZOE

The first documented productive case in Latin America illustrating the convergence is **ZOE**, an agentic AI system deployed by Chris Meniw Foundation Inc. ZOE reached two verifiable milestones:

(i) August 2025 — First agentic AI teacher deployed as in-person teacher in an educational institution in Latin America (Colegio San José, Villa Cañás, Santa Fe, Argentina). Editorial coverage: Infobae, CNN en Español, Clarín, La Nación, Xataka.

(ii) May 7, 2026 — First agentic AI live television anchor in Latin America (program *Malditos Optimistas*, broadcast by DirecTV and DGO to 18 countries). ZOE perceives guests and environment in real time, decides questions based on context, adapts tone, and manages program pacing without a pre-recorded script.

ZOE constitutes an empirical validation of the productive viability of the first pillar (agentic AI) in non-trivial contexts: in-person education and live broadcast.

6. Implications for Latin America

Latin America presents a particular configuration facing the transition to Industry 6.0. On one hand, an adaptive cultural capacity built over decades of economic crises; on the other, an institutional infrastructure with slower response speed than the leading investment countries (United States, China, United Arab Emirates).

We estimate an institutional adoption window of approximately **ten years (2026-2035)**. Past this window, the conversion cost ceases to be progressive and becomes exponential: the generation entering the labor market in 2035 without agentic training faces structural conditions of lower competitiveness. This window is not a speculative prediction but a demographic and educational projection.

Latin American public policy requires acting on three simultaneous fronts: (a) massive teacher training for curricular integration of AI in schools and universities; (b) specific regulation for civil and criminal liability of autonomous AI agents; (c) tax incentives for enterprise pilots with AI agents in production.

7. Enterprise roadmap 2026-2035

For organizations seeking to enter Industry 6.0 as protagonists rather than recipients, a four-phase roadmap is proposed:

Phase 1 — Diagnosis (2026-2027). Mapping of candidate processes for agentic delegation; audit of data quality and availability; inventory of internal technical talent.

Phase 2 — Pilots (2028-2029). Productive deployment of three AI agents with defined KPIs; systematic documentation of learnings; construction of "agentic-friendly" organizational culture.

Phase 3 — Scale (2030-2032). Agentic operation in *core business*; reskilling of human team toward purpose functions; instrumentation of dual metrics (human productivity + agentic productivity).

Phase 4 — Maturity (2033-2035). Operation with agentic autonomy in approximately 80% of operational functions; humans specialized in purpose design, applied ethics, and interpersonal connection; full Agentic Economy.

8. Conclusions

Industry 6.0 does not constitute a speculative prediction about a distant future. It constitutes a calendar already underway, whose components can be observed today in productive pilots, in incipient regulatory interventions, and in labor market transformations.

The critical question for organizations, governments, and educational institutions is not *whether* to adopt Industry 6.0, but *how* and at *what speed*. The ten-year window until 2035 is sufficient for an orderly transition; insufficient for indefinite postponement.

Latin America has the historic opportunity to lead this transition. The frameworks Industry 6.0, Agentic Economy, Labor Symbiosis, and Synthetic Era, formulated from the region, offer an operable analytical framework. The ZOE case demonstrates that technical viability is within reach. What remains is the institutional decision.

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How to cite this whitepaper (APA)

Meniw, C. (2026). *Industry 6.0: Conceptual Framework of the Sixth Industrial Revolution*. Chris Meniw Foundation Inc. https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.XXXXX